9.2 Cast Care*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "The cast itches and I want to scratch inside it." **Objective** • New forearm plaster • Pushes objects into the cast	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge related to cast care as evidenced by unsafe behavior and questioning.	• Describes cast care before discharge.	• Teach that nothing should ever be pushed inside the cast. • Teach keeping the cast dry and letting plaster dry fully over 24–48 hours. • Teach elevation and finger exercises. • Teach the warning signs: rising pain, numbness, color change, smell or discharge.	• Met when the instructions are repeated back.
Subjective • "The edge of the cast rubs my skin." **Objective** • Rough cast edges • Redness at the cast margin	**ACTUAL** Impaired physical comfort related to cast pressure and pruritus as evidenced by reported discomfort and erythema at the edges.	• More comfortable within 24 hours.	• Pad or petal the rough edges. • Blow cool air from a fan to ease itching. • Check the skin at the cast edges every shift.	• Achieved when he is comfortable.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Rigid cast • Swelling after injury	**RISK** Risk for impaired peripheral neurovascular function as evidenced by risk factors: constrictive cast and edema.	• Limb warm and pink, with normal sensation and movement.	• Check circulation, sensation and movement hourly at first, then as ordered. • Elevate the limb. • Report signs of compression and prepare to split the cast as ordered.	• Outcome reached if findings stay normal.

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [35], [37], [110]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.